



Mock Coding Interview Rubric

Assessment By:

Student Name:

Date:

0 ▾ Understanding the Problem (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student fully understands the problem. They ask clarifying questions, restate the problem clearly, and identify edge cases. No misunderstandings, and they accurately rephrase the problem to show deep comprehension.
- **3-4 Points:** Student mostly understands the problem, but may miss minor clarifications or some edge cases. Rephrasing is mostly accurate.
- **1-2 Points:** Student shows confusion about the problem, asks very few clarifying questions, and does not account for edge cases.
- **0 Points:** Student does not understand the problem, fails to ask any clarifying questions, or jumps into coding without confirming understanding.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Solution Brainstorming & Planning (0-10 Points)

- **9-10 Points:** Student proposes multiple solutions, including brute-force and optimized ones. They explain time and space complexity for each solution in detail and justify their final choice based on efficiency and scalability.
- **7-8 Points:** Student proposes at least two solutions and discusses time/space complexity but lacks some depth in evaluating edge cases or optimization.
- **5-6 Points:** Student proposes only one solution and gives a general explanation of time/space complexity without comparing alternatives.
- **1-4 Points:** Student rushes into coding without adequate brainstorming or fails to propose a valid solution.
- **0 Points:** No brainstorming or planning before coding.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Coding Implementation (0-10 Points)

- **9-10 Points:** Code is clean, organized, and efficiently written. Student explains their code while writing it, adds relevant comments, and considers edge cases. Minimal or no syntax errors.
- **7-8 Points:** Code works but lacks some clarity or structure. Explanations are given but may be rushed or incomplete. Some minor issues with syntax.
- **5-6 Points:** Code is functional but lacks clean structure or fails to handle edge cases. Explanations are minimal or unclear.
- **1-4 Points:** Code is incomplete, poorly structured, or fails to solve the problem. Many syntax errors or missing logic.
- **0 Points:** No valid code implementation.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Problem Solving Approach & Logical Thinking (0-10 Points)

- **9-10 Points:** Student demonstrates strong problem-solving skills by breaking down the problem into logical steps and efficiently applying appropriate data structures/algorithms.
- **7-8 Points:** Student demonstrates good problem-solving skills but may overlook some optimizations or data structure choices.
- **5-6 Points:** Student shows basic problem-solving skills but misses key improvements or uses an inefficient approach.
- **1-4 Points:** Student struggles with breaking down the problem and applying appropriate logic. Frequently stuck or unsure of the next step.
- **0 Points:** No logical approach or problem-solving strategy applied.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Communication & Explanation (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student consistently explains their thought process clearly and concisely while coding. They make it easy for the interviewer to follow along and understand their approach.
- **3-4 Points:** Student explains their thought process most of the time but may leave out key details or over-rely on code comments.
- **1-2 Points:** Student gives minimal explanations, leaving the interviewer guessing about their thought process.
- **0 Points:** No explanation given, making it difficult to follow their approach.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Time & Space Complexity Analysis (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student clearly explains and correctly analyzes both time and space complexity, using Big-O notation. They evaluate different parts of their solution effectively.
- **3-4 Points:** Student mentions time and space complexity but provides a somewhat shallow or partially incorrect analysis.
- **1-2 Points:** Student gives a vague or incomplete explanation of time and space complexity.
- **0 Points:** No mention or understanding of time and space complexity.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Optimization & Improvement (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student actively discusses potential optimizations and improvements, even if the initial solution is correct. They consider alternative approaches and ways to refine their code.
- **3-4 Points:** Student discusses some optimizations but does not fully explore improvements beyond the initial solution.
- **1-2 Points:** Student gives minimal thought to optimization or fails to improve an inefficient solution.
- **0 Points:** No mention of optimization or improvements.



Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Handling Edge Cases & Testing (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student thoroughly tests the code with a variety of edge cases, including boundary conditions and potential failure scenarios. Code handles all edge cases effectively.
- **3-4 Points:** Student considers and tests a few edge cases but misses some important ones.
- **1-2 Points:** Student gives minimal attention to edge cases and testing, resulting in an incomplete or incorrect solution.
- **0 Points:** No edge cases tested or considered.

Feedback/Comments:

0 ▾ Ability to Adapt & Respond to Hints (0-5 Points)

- **5 Points:** Student adapts well when given feedback or a hint, quickly incorporating it into their approach. They maintain a positive attitude and continue problem-solving effectively.
- **3-4 Points:** Student adapts somewhat to feedback but needs extra prompting to adjust their solution.
- **1-2 Points:** Student struggles to incorporate feedback or hints, requiring significant guidance.
- **0 Points:** Student is unable to adapt or respond effectively to feedback, leading to further confusion or incorrect solutions.

Feedback/Comments:

Final Score: ____ / 60